

- (c) Buildings of worship (d) Art and architecture
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (a)

The use of burnt bricks in the construction of buildings was one of the main features of the Indus Valley Civilization. Burnt bricks were used in abundance in Harappa and Mohenjo Daro. In Lothal, burnt bricks were used in the construction of drainage. Well planned architecture, advanced trade and commerce were other main feature of this civilisation.

7. Which of the following animals was not known to the people of the Indus Valley Civilization?

- (a) Bull (b) Horse
(c) Elephant (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

Among the given options evidence of cow and elephant have been found. A seal of zebu bull has been found. Seals depicting elephant has also been found. There is some dispute regarding horse but latest excavation has revealed the evidence of horse. However Horse did not play any major role during Indus Valley Civilisation. BPSC has accepted (b) as correct answer.

8. Which of the following is a Harappan port?

- (a) Alexandria (b) Lothal
(c) Mahasthangarh (d) Nagapattinam

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Lothal is the only place of Indus Valley civilization from where the pieces of evidence of ports have been found which is located in the Gujarat State.

9. Which of the following is a Harappan Site in Gujarat?

- (a) Lothal (b) Dabarkot
(c) Kalibanga (d) Rakhigarhi
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Who among the following was not associated with the excavation of Harappa and Mohenjodaro?

- (a) R. D. Banerjee (b) K.N. Dikshit
(c) M.S. Vats (d) V.A. Smith

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

In 1921, Daya Ram Sahni excavated Harappa. In 1926-27 and 1933-34, M.S. Vats was associated with the excavation of Harappa. MohenjoDaro was discovered in 1922 by Rakhal Das Banerjee. In addition to him, some other scholars like K.N. Dixit, Ernest Mackay, Aurel Stein, A. Ghosh and J.P. Joshi also contributed to the excavation of this civilization. Hence, it is clear that V.A. Smith was not associated with the discovery of Harappan Civilization rather was a British Indologist and art historian.

11. According to the report of IIT Kharagpur study group, continuous low rainfall for how many years was the cause of fall of the Indus Valley civilization?

- (a) 600 years (b) 700 years
(c) 800 years (d) 900 years
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

According to the reports of IIT Kharagpur, the continuous low or negligible rainfall for 900 years was the cause of fall of the Indus Valley Civilization. In other words, it can be said that continuous drought for 900 years led to the fall of Indus Valley Civilization.

Vedic Age

1. When did the use of iron begin in Indian subcontinent?

- (a) Around 9000 years ago
(b) Around 12000 years ago
(c) Around 6000 years ago
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (e)

The history of early iron smelting, practiced by the tribal artisans in different regions of ancient India dates back to 1300 to 1200 B.C. Most archaeologists accept around 1000 B.C. as start of the iron age in subcontinent. So earliest use of Iron in the Indian subcontinent can be placed around 3000 years ago. Hence option (e) None of the above is correct.

2. Which Mandala of Rig Veda is completely dedicated to 'Soma'?

- (a) Seventh Mandala (b) Eighth Mandala
(c) Ninth Mandala (d) Tenth Mandala

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)